THE METHOD · THE 90-DAY PROGRAM

LESSON GUIDE

Teaching notes for all 105 lessons. What to say, the one idea to land, and what the member does next.

For James – the script for recording each lesson and for the teaching half of every live call. Where a personal story belongs there's a [STORY] prompt to fill in your own words.

HOW TO USE THIS

RECORD IT, *or teach it live.*

RECORDING A LESSON

Each lesson is a 5–12 minute video. Open with the big idea. Hit the talking points in order. Tell the story. End with the action – one thing, said plainly. Don't script it word for word; read the points, then talk.

ON THE LIVE CALL

The teaching half of the call is the week's course. Pick the three lessons that matter most for the people in the room, cover their big ideas, then open it up. The Live Call Plan has the per-week page.

EVERY LESSON HAS THE SAME FIVE PARTS

BIG IDEA the one thing they walk away with · TALKING POINTS what to say · STORY yours, or a prompt · ACTION what they do now · and one ASSIGNMENT per course.

00

COURSE 00 · WEEK 1 · · 6 LESSONS

START HERE

Welcome to The Method.

This is where you start. In this course you find your stage, set your target and map out your first seven days. It takes less than an hour. Do it properly and the next twelve weeks make sense.

YOU LEAVE WITH Your stage, your target, and your first seven days mapped out.

00.1 WELCOME TO THE METHOD

00.1

BIG IDEA

This is the exact process I used to build my own companies and train the people who now run them. You build the business and you build yourself. One project, ninety days.

TALKING POINTS

- Welcome. This isn't theory. It's what I did, written down in order, so you can do it too.
- I built my own companies and I trained the people who now run them. That's the process you're getting.
- A finished business has a definition. You can leave it, sell it, or run it from your phone on the other side of the world, and it holds. Anything less is a job you own.
- Ninety days. One course a week. One live call a week. One assignment at the end of every course.
- You get four things: the weekly live call, the Classroom, the Vault and the community. Use all four.
- Time freedom, location freedom, financial freedom. We design them in from day one. We don't hope for them at the end.

STORY

I walked my brother from someone who just wanted to have a company to running one fully remote at six figures a month. This is the same path. [STORY: the moment you realized your process could be taught to someone else]

ACTION

→ Block one hour this week and finish every lesson in Course 00 before the next live call.

00.2 HOW TO WIN IN HERE

00.2

BIG IDEA

The people who win in here do the assignments, show their numbers and ask specific questions. Watching isn't doing.

TALKING POINTS

- Every course ends with one assignment. Do it before you move on. That's where the results are.
- Run the weekly rhythm. Monday, post your target for the week and the one number you're moving. Friday, post your wins and your misses. Both count.
- Come to the live call with one real question. Thirty minutes of teaching, thirty minutes of your questions. Every call is recorded.
- Ask specific questions. 'How do I get clients?' gets you less than 'Here's my offer, my market, and what's broken.'

- Show your work. Wins, misses, work in progress. This room runs on real reps.
- What's shared here stays here. No pitching. Help people. If you've helped someone, a DM is fine.

STORY

[STORY: someone you've coached who moved fast because they did the reps, or one who stalled because they only watched]

ACTION

→ Put the live call, a Monday post and a Friday post in your calendar as recurring events for the next twelve weeks.

00.3 FIND YOUR STAGE

The five stages – and exactly where you start.

BIG IDEA

There are five stages. Pick the one you're actually in, not the one you want to be in. Your stage tells you where to push hardest.

TALKING POINTS

- Stage 0 is starting from zero. No business yet. Push hardest on Course 02.
- Stage 1 is doing it all. You find the work, do the work and chase the invoice. Feast or famine. Push hardest on Courses 03 to 05.
- Stage 2 is it runs through you. Real revenue, around ten to thirty thousand a month, and every client needs you. Push hardest on Courses 06 to 09.
- Stage 3 is a team, not a machine. People on payroll, around thirty to a hundred thousand a month, and you're still the bottleneck. Push hardest on 09 to 12. Stage 4 is owner, not operator. It runs without you. Push on 13 and 14.
- Here's the test. If you stopped working for two weeks, what happens to revenue? Your honest answer tells you your stage.
- Most people are one stage behind where they think they are. That's normal. Everyone still runs all ninety days, in order. Your stage just tells you where to spend extra effort.

STORY

[STORY: a time you thought you were further along than you were, and what showed you the truth]

ACTION

→ Write down your stage, your revenue for each of the last three months, and which of the ten problems you're stuck on: leads, marketing, sales, retention, churn, recruiting, delegation, managing a team, leadership or scaling.

00.4 SET YOUR TARGET

The monthly number, the date, and the life it pays for.

BIG IDEA

A target is three things: a monthly number, a date and the life it pays for. Without all three, it's a wish.

TALKING POINTS

- Pick one monthly revenue number. Not a range. One number.
- Put a date on it. A real date, on a calendar.
- Then write down the life it pays for. Where you live, how you spend your week, who you spend it with. That's what gets you through the hard days.

- Make it big enough that you'd have to change how you work to hit it. If you can hit it doing what you're doing now, it's not a target.
- Make it real enough to work backwards. In Course 11 we turn it into a weekly lead number.
- Nobody actually wants a company. They want what it pays for. Start there.

STORY

[STORY: the first real target you set, and what happened when you hit it or missed it]

ACTION

→ Write your monthly number, your date, and three sentences on the life it pays for. Keep it where you'll see it every morning.

00.5 THE JAMES METHOD IN TEN MINUTES

Build the business, build yourself. Three moves, ninety days.

BIG IDEA

Build the business, build yourself. Three moves over ninety days: Money In, The Machine, Step Out. Rich · Fit · Sick runs underneath all of it.

TALKING POINTS

- My process is simple. You build the business and you build yourself. Not two projects. One.
- Move one, days 1 to 30, is Money In. An offer people understand, a steady flow of leads, and you selling it with confidence. Cash coming in every week.
- Move two, days 31 to 60, is The Machine. Someone else delivers. Systems, SOPs, a CRM, your first hires. Clients stay, and the work moves without you touching it.
- Move three, days 61 to 90, is Step Out. The numbers run on a scoreboard, the team runs the day, and you run the company from your phone, anywhere.
- Underneath all ninety days is Rich · Fit · Sick. Rich is the work, the learning, a rich life. Fit is train every day. Sick is mindset, reading, style and the standard you hold.
- The order matters. You can't build a machine with no money coming in, and you can't step out of something that isn't a machine yet.

STORY

This is the same path I walked my brother through, from wanting a company to running one fully remote at six figures a month. [STORY: one moment from that journey that shows the three moves in action]

ACTION

→ Write the three moves on one page. Next to each, write one sentence on what it would change in your business right now.

00.6 YOUR FIRST SEVEN DAYS

The checklist every new member runs.

BIG IDEA

Your first week is a checklist, not a mood. Run it and you start the program with momentum.

TALKING POINTS

- Day one, finish Course 00. It takes less than an hour.
- Day two, post your stage, your target and your date in the community.
- Day three, start Course 01 and write your daily standard: train, read, one deep work block, one sales action.

- Days four to six, hold the standard every day. If you have no business yet, start Course 02. If you do, start Course 03.
- Before the live call, write your one real question, with your numbers attached.
- Day seven, post your wins and your misses. Both count.

STORY

[STORY: what your own first week looked like when you started your first company]

ACTION

→ Copy the seven-day checklist into your calendar today, one item per day, and tick each one off as you go.

THE ASSIGNMENT – COURSE 00

Post your stage, your target and your date in the community.

Post three lines in the community: your stage, your monthly target and your date. Be honest about the stage. Most people are one behind where they think. A good post reads like 'Stage 1. $15K a month by March 31.' Add one line on the life it pays for and one line on the problem you're stuck on, so the room can actually help you.

In the Vault: The AI-Proof Creative (guide)

01

COURSE 01 · WEEK 1 · · 7 LESSONS

THE STANDARD

Mindset, and Rich · Fit · Sick.

This course is about you. A business never outgrows the standard of the person running it. We name the beliefs that have been capping you, and you write a daily standard you hold for fourteen days.

YOU LEAVE WITH Your daily standard written down – and the beliefs that were capping you, named.

01.1 YOU ARE NOT THE PRODUCT. THE STANDARD IS.

01.1

BIG IDEA

If you are the product, the business can't grow past your hours. When the standard is the product, other people can deliver it, and that's what lets you step out.

TALKING POINTS

- Most service owners think clients are buying them. They're buying a result, delivered to a standard.
- If the result only happens when you do it, you own a job. If it happens because there's a standard, you own a business.
- Write down what good looks like for your work. Specifically. Turnaround time, quality, how the client is spoken to.
- A standard someone else can read and hit is a standard you can hire for, train to and check against.
- You can't train someone to be you. You can train them to a standard.
- Raise your own standard first. Your team will never hold a higher one than you do.

STORY

[STORY: the moment you realized clients were paying for the standard, not for you personally]

ACTION

→ Write one paragraph that defines good for your core service, covering quality, speed and communication, clear enough that someone else could check work against it.

01.2 THE CEILING YOU INSTALLED YOURSELF

01.2

BIG IDEA

Most of what caps your income is a belief you picked up somewhere and never checked. Name it and you can replace it.

TALKING POINTS

- Every business has a ceiling. Usually the owner put it there.
- Listen for the sentences. 'Nobody in my market pays that.' 'If I don't do it myself, it won't be right.' 'I'm not a salesperson.' Those are ceilings.
- For each one, ask two questions. Where did I learn this? What's the evidence it's true today?
- I charge ten times the market. That's only possible once you stop treating the market rate as a ceiling.
- Replace each belief with a sentence you can act on, and one action that tests it this week.
- You won't feel ready first. You act, and the belief follows the evidence.

STORY

[STORY: a belief that capped you early on, and what broke it]

ACTION

→ Write your top three limiting beliefs about money, selling or letting go of the work. Next to each, write one action this week that tests it.

01.3 RICH · FIT · SICK

Rich – the work, the learning, a rich life. Fit – train every day. Sick – mindset, reading, style.

BIG IDEA

Rich, Fit and Sick run underneath all ninety days. The business and the person get built at the same time.

TALKING POINTS

- Rich is the work, the learning and a rich life. Not just money in the account.
- Fit is train every day. Your energy is the business's energy.
- Sick is mindset, reading and style. The standard you hold in how you think, what you learn and how you show up.
- Each one gets a daily action. Rich is one deep work block and one sales action. Fit is train. Sick is read.
- When one of the three slips, the other two usually follow. Track all three.
- This isn't a side project to the business. You're the one running the business, so it is the business.

STORY

[STORY: why you named it Rich · Fit · Sick, and what each one looks like in your own week]

ACTION

→ Write one daily action for Rich, one for Fit and one for Sick, and do all three tomorrow.

01.4 FREEDOM IS THE SPEC, NOT THE PRIZE

Design for time, location and financial freedom from day one.

BIG IDEA

Time, location and financial freedom are design requirements. Build them in from day one, or you'll build a business that traps you.

TALKING POINTS

- Most people build the business first and hope freedom shows up at the end. It doesn't.
- Treat freedom like a spec. Before every decision, ask one question: does this make me more needed, or less?
- Time freedom means the work doesn't need your hours. Build every service so someone else can deliver it.
- Location freedom means nothing needs you in the room. Pick tools, processes and clients that work remote.
- Financial freedom means margin and recurring revenue, not one big month. Contracts over one-off jobs.
- The finish line is a business you can leave, sell, or run from your phone on the other side of the world, and it holds.

STORY

I walked my brother from wanting a company to running one fully remote at six figures a month. [STORY: the

early decisions that made running it remote possible]

ACTION

→ List your last five business decisions and mark each one 'more needed' or 'less needed'. Reverse one of the 'more needed' ones this week.

01.5 BREAKING FEAST OR FAMINE

Chase a job, do it all, get paid, burn out, start again. How to get off the loop.

BIG IDEA

Feast or famine is a loop: chase a job, do it all, get paid, burn out, start again. You break it by selling every day and moving clients onto recurring work.

TALKING POINTS

- Here's the loop. Chase a job, do it all, get paid, burn out, start again.
- It happens because when you're busy delivering, you stop selling. Then the work ends and the pipeline is empty.
- Fix one is a sales action every single day, busy or not. That's why it's in your daily standard.
- Fix two is recurring revenue. Every client should be on a contract. We cover how in Course 03.
- Fix three is getting out of delivery, so delivery can't starve sales. That's The Machine.
- Our clients stay 12, 24, 38 months. That's what the other side of feast or famine looks like.

STORY

[STORY: your own worst famine month, and what you changed after it]

ACTION

→ Write down your revenue for each of the last six months and circle the dips. Next to each dip, write what you stopped doing the month before.

01.6 DISCIPLINE OVER MOTIVATION

Habits, routine and standards – what the Marine Corps taught me about showing up.

BIG IDEA

Motivation shows up when it wants. Discipline is a routine you run anyway. Build the routine, then hold the standard.

TALKING POINTS

- Motivation is a feeling. You can't schedule a feeling. You can schedule a routine.
- The Marine Corps taught me about showing up. You don't decide each morning whether you're going. It's already decided.
- Make the decisions once. What time you train, when you read, when your deep work block is, when you do your sales action. Then stop renegotiating.
- Start smaller than your ego wants. A standard you hold for fourteen days beats a big one you drop on day three.
- Track it every day. Tick or no tick. The tracker tells the truth when your mood doesn't.
- Miss a day, don't miss two. Get straight back on.

STORY

[STORY: a specific moment in the Marine Corps that taught you what showing up means]

ACTION

→ Put your four daily actions in your calendar at fixed times for the next fourteen days.

01.7 WALKTHROUGH: MY DAY, MY WEEK

How I actually run my time.

BIG IDEA

This is how I actually run my time, the structure behind the standard. Take the structure, not my exact times.

TALKING POINTS

- I'm going to show you my real calendar. Not the ideal version. The real one.
- The fixed blocks go in first: training, reading, deep work. Nothing gets booked over them. [WALKTHROUGH: show your daily fixed blocks and when they happen]
- Then the weekly rhythm: team meetings, the scoreboard, sales time. [WALKTHROUGH: show your week and which day holds which meeting]
- Everything else fits around those blocks. If something doesn't fit, it gets handed off or it doesn't happen.
- Look at what's missing from my calendar as much as what's on it. That's the work I no longer touch. [WALKTHROUGH: name the work you've handed off]
- Copy the structure. Your times and your blocks will be different, and that's fine.

STORY

[STORY: what your calendar looked like back when everything ran through you]

ACTION

→ Build your ideal week in your calendar: fixed blocks first, weekly meetings second, everything else after.

THE ASSIGNMENT – COURSE 01

Write your daily standard – train, read, one deep work block, one sales action – and hold it for 14 days.

Write your daily standard as four lines, each with a time and a minimum: train, read, one deep work block, one sales action. For example: 'Train at 6am, 30 minutes minimum. Read 10 pages. Deep work 9 to 11, phone off. One sales action before noon.' Track it every day for fourteen days in the Daily Standard tracker. Good is fourteen out of fourteen. Honest is posting your tally in the community on day fourteen, misses included.

In the Vault: Daily Standard tracker

02

COURSE 02 · WEEK 2 · MONEY IN · IF YOU'RE STARTING FROM ZERO · 7 LESSONS

START FROM ZERO

The online service business.

This course is for you if you have no business yet. We're building an online service business, the fastest way I know to go from nothing to cash coming in. By the end you have a service picked, a first offer written and ten conversations booked.

YOU LEAVE WITH A service picked, a first offer written, and your first ten conversations booked.

02.1 WHY A SERVICE BUSINESS

02.1

BIG IDEA

A service business is the fastest way from zero to cash. No inventory, no product to build, and people already pay for it.

TALKING POINTS

- You don't need a product, an app or an investor. You need something people already pay for and a way to deliver it.
- Service businesses get paid up front or on delivery. Cash comes in from your first client.
- You can start it from a laptop and run it from anywhere. That's location freedom from day one.
- It's the model I've built my own companies on.
- The catch: if you do all the work yourself, you've built a job. So from day one, we build it so someone else can deliver.
- Recurring service clients are the most valuable thing a small business can have. Our clients stay 12, 24, 38 months.

STORY

[STORY: why you started with a service business instead of a product]

ACTION

→ Write down three services you've personally paid someone for in the last year, and what you paid for each.

02.2 SERVICE BUSINESS ARBITRAGE

02.2

BIG IDEA

You sell the outcome at a value price and pay a skilled person the market rate to deliver it. The gap is your margin.

TALKING POINTS

- Arbitrage is simple. The client pays for the result. You pay a skilled person the market rate to do the work. You keep the difference.
- Your job is the parts most people can't do: find the client, sell the outcome and hold the standard.
- Charge on value, pay the market rate. That's the margin rule we come back to in Course 11.
- This isn't cutting corners. The client gets a better result because someone is managing it to a standard.

- Know your gap before you sell. If there's no room between what you charge and what the work costs, pick a different service or a higher price.
- I charge ten times the market. You get there by selling the result, not the hours.

STORY

[STORY: the first job you sold where someone else did the work]

ACTION

→ For one service you're considering, write three numbers: the price a client would pay, the cost to have someone else deliver it, and the gap.

02.3 PICK YOUR SERVICE

What people already pay for, that you can sell and someone else can do.

BIG IDEA

Pick something people already pay for, that you can sell, and that someone else can do. It has to pass all three, or you keep looking.

TALKING POINTS

- Test one: do people already pay for it? Search for it. If you can find businesses selling it and clients buying it, the market is there.
- Test two: can you sell it? You should understand the buyer and be able to explain the result in one sentence.
- Test three: can someone else do it? If the only person on earth who can deliver it is you, it fails.
- Extra points if it's recurring, something clients need every month, not once.
- Don't pick on passion. Pick on demand. You can learn to love a business that pays.
- Pick one. Not three. You can add offers later. That's Course 13.

STORY

[STORY: how you picked your first service, and what you'd tell yourself now]

ACTION

→ Score five service ideas against the three tests, using the Service picker worksheet once it's in the Vault, and circle the one that passes all three.

02.4 SET IT UP IN A WEEKEND

A name, a one-page offer, a payment link and a simple CRM.

BIG IDEA

You need four things to open: a name, a one-page offer, a payment link and a simple CRM. Do it in a weekend and stop there.

TALKING POINTS

- A name. Clear beats clever. Check the domain and the social handle are free, then move on.
- A one-page offer: who it's for, the result, what's included, the price and how to start.
- A payment link. If someone says yes on a call, you take the money on the call. Not 'I'll send an invoice later.'
- A simple CRM. One place for every lead and every conversation: name, stage, next step, date. A spreadsheet is fine to start.
- That's it. No agonizing over a logo, no big website, no business cards. None of those book a conversation.
- By Monday morning you should be able to send someone your offer and take payment.

STORY

[STORY: what you spent too long on when you set up your first company]

ACTION

→ By Sunday night, have your name, your one-page offer, your payment link and your CRM done.

02.5 YOUR FIRST CLIENT

Start with who you already know – and what to say to them.

BIG IDEA

Your first client is almost always someone you already know, or someone they know. Start there, and say it plainly.

TALKING POINTS

- Write a list of everyone you know. Phone contacts, followers, old colleagues, family, friends. Aim for a hundred names.
- Mark who could buy it, and who knows someone who could.
- Send a plain message: 'I've started a [service] business helping [who] get [result]. Is that something you need, or do you know someone who does?'
- Don't pitch in the message. The goal is a conversation, not a sale over text.
- On the call, ask about their problem first. Then say the offer, say the number, and stop talking.
- Your first client gets your best work. When you deliver, ask for a testimonial and a referral.

STORY

[STORY: who your first client was and how that first conversation went]

ACTION

→ Build a list of a hundred people you know, send the message to thirty of them, and book every reply into a call.

02.6 YOUR FIRST DELIVERY

Find the person who does the work, manage the job, keep the client.

BIG IDEA

You don't have to do the work. You have to find the person who does it, manage the job and keep the client.

TALKING POINTS

- Find the person before you need them. Line up two or three people who can do the work, and look at their past work.
- Run a small paid trial first. Test the work before you commit.
- Write down what good looks like: the deliverable, the deadline, the standard. Send it to them in writing.
- Put a date on every step, and update the client before they ask.
- Check the work before the client sees it. You own the quality, even if you didn't do it.
- The goal of the first delivery isn't just to deliver. It's to keep the client and turn them into your next one.

STORY

[STORY: a first delivery that went sideways, and what it taught you about managing the work]

ACTION

→ Find three people who could deliver your service, review their past work, and message each one for their rate and availability.

02.7 MISTAKES THAT KILL IT IN MONTH ONE

And how to avoid every one of them.

BIG IDEA

Most new service businesses die of the same few mistakes. Know them in advance and you skip them.

TALKING POINTS

- Mistake one is building instead of selling. Weeks on a logo and a website, zero conversations. Conversations come first.
- Mistake two is picking three services. One service, one buyer, one offer.
- Mistake three is pricing low to get the first yes. Low prices bring the wrong clients and leave no room to pay someone else. Price on the result.
- Mistake four is doing all the delivery yourself. You stop selling and you're back in feast or famine. Line up your delivery person before you close.
- Mistake five is stopping outreach once you land a client. One sales action every day, busy or not.
- Mistake six is no follow-up. Most deals close after the fifth touch. Most people stop at one.

STORY

[STORY: a month-one mistake you made yourself, or watched someone make]

ACTION

→ Go down the list, mark every mistake you're already making, and put the fix for each one in your calendar this week.

THE ASSIGNMENT – COURSE 02

Pick one service and book ten conversations this week.

Pick one service, the one that passes all three tests, and put it at the top of your one-page offer. Then book ten conversations this week. Not ten messages sent: ten calls on the calendar with people who could buy or refer. Start with the people you already know and log every one in your CRM with a next step and a date. Good looks like ten names, ten times booked, and a Friday post in the community saying how many turned into proposals.

In the Vault: Service picker worksheet, One-page offer template

03

COURSE 03 · WEEK 2 · MONEY IN · 7 LESSONS

THE OFFER & PRICING

What you sell, and what you charge for it.

This week is about what you sell and what you charge for it. Most people have a skill. Very few have an offer. By the end of the week you'll have one sentence anyone understands, three packages, and a price you can say without flinching.

YOU LEAVE WITH One offer people understand in a sentence – priced on value, packaged as recurring.

03.1 SELL THE OUTCOME, NOT THE TASK

03.1

BIG IDEA

Nobody buys the task. They buy what happens after it. Sell that.

TALKING POINTS

- Your client doesn't want the task. They want the result the task gets them.
- A realtor doesn't want photos. They want the listing sold, faster and for more.
- When you sell the task, you get compared on price. When you sell the outcome, you get compared on results.
- Here's the test. If your offer describes what you do, rewrite it so it describes what they get.
- Ask your best clients why they hired you and write down their exact words. That's your outcome.
- The task is the how. Keep it in the back. Lead with the what.

STORY

[STORY: a client who hired you for the task but stayed for the outcome, and what they actually cared about]

ACTION

→ List every service you sell. Next to each one, write the outcome the client actually pays for, in their words, not yours.

03.2 THE OFFER FORMULA

03.2

BIG IDEA

A good offer is one sentence: who it's for, what they get, how fast, and what they don't have to worry about.

TALKING POINTS

- Here's the formula. I help [who] get [outcome] in [timeframe] without [the thing they're afraid of].
- Who means one type of buyer. 'Small businesses' is not a who. Property managers in one city is a who.
- The outcome has to be something they can see or count. More leads. More leases. More booked calls.
- The timeframe makes it real. Without one, it's a wish.
- If someone can't repeat it back after hearing it once, it's too complicated.
- Write ten versions and read them out loud. Keep the one that sounds like you talking, not like a website.

ACTION

→ Write ten versions of your offer sentence using the formula, read each one out loud, and pick the one you'd say on a call.

03.3 PACKAGE IT

Project, package, retainer – and why each one exists.

BIG IDEA

Three ways to sell the same skill. The project gets you in the door, the package makes it easy to buy, and the retainer builds the business.

TALKING POINTS

- A project is one job, one price, one delivery. Good for a first yes. Bad as a business model.
- A package bundles the work into a set result at a set price. The buyer doesn't build the order. You do.
- A retainer is the same result every month, on a contract. That's where the business is.
- Give them three options. Most people pick the middle, so build the middle to be the one you want them to buy.
- Every package has a name, what's in, what's out, a timeline and a price. Nothing vague.
- Don't build ten packages. Build three. More choice means a slower yes.

ACTION

→ Draft three packages: a starter project, a core package and a monthly retainer. Each one gets a name, what's in, what's out, a timeline and a price.

03.4 RECURRING REVENUE

Why every client should be on a contract, and how to get them there.

BIG IDEA

One-off clients mean every month starts at zero. Contracts mean every month starts ahead.

TALKING POINTS

- If every month starts at zero, you don't have a business. You have a hunt.
- Recurring revenue is what lets you hire, plan and step out. Nothing else in this program works without it.
- Find the part of your work that repeats. Content every month. Leads every month. A clean building every week. Sell that.
- Put it on a contract with a minimum term and a clear way to renew.
- The easiest retainer to sell is to a client who already bought a project. Ask at delivery, when they're happiest.
- Our clients stay 12, 24, 38 months. That doesn't happen by accident. It starts with an offer built to recur.

STORY

> Our clients stay 12, 24, 38 months. [STORY: how your first one-off client became a monthly client]

ACTION

→ Pick your three happiest past or current clients and offer each one a monthly version of the work you already did for them.

03.5 PRICE ON VALUE

How I charge ten times the market – and hold it.

BIG IDEA

Price comes from what the outcome is worth to the buyer. Not your hours. Not what everyone else charges.

TALKING POINTS

- The market rate is what people charge for the task. I don't sell the task. That's how I charge ten times the market.
- Work out what the outcome is worth to the client in dollars. An empty unit for a month. A lost listing. A slow season. Price against that number.
- If your price is a small slice of what the result is worth, it's an easy yes, even at ten times the market.
- Raise your price on new clients first. Don't apologise. Don't explain. Just quote the new number.
- Holding it means no discounts to close. If they need it cheaper, take something out of the package. Never cut the price on the same work.
- If nobody ever pushes back on your price, you're too cheap.

STORY

[STORY: the first time you raised your price: the number before, the number after, and what the client said]

ACTION

→ Write down in dollars what your outcome is worth to one real client. Set your core package price against that number and quote it on your next call.

03.6 GUARANTEES AND RISK REVERSAL

Remove the risk and win the yes – done properly.

BIG IDEA

People don't say no to you. They say no to the risk. Take it off the table with a guarantee you can actually keep.

TALKING POINTS

- Every buyer is asking one question: what if this doesn't work? Answer it before they ask.
- A good guarantee is specific. What you'll deliver, by when, and what happens if you don't.
- Guarantee what you control. The work, the deadline, the revisions. Not results that depend on things you don't control.
- If you miss, you make it right. Redo it, add a month free, or refund. Pick one and write it down.
- Put conditions on it. They show up, they give feedback on time, they use the work. A guarantee is a deal, not a gift.
- Done properly, a guarantee costs you almost nothing, because you deliver. If it costs you a lot, the problem is delivery.

ACTION

→ Write one guarantee for your core package: what you promise, by when, what you do if you miss, and what the client has to do on their side.

03.7 TEARDOWN: A REAL OFFER, REBUILT LIVE

Before and after, line by line.

BIG IDEA

Watch an offer go from a list of tasks to one sentence, three packages and a price. Then do the same to yours.

TALKING POINTS

- Here's the offer as it came in. Notice how much of it is about the person selling, not the person buying.
- Line one: who is it for? If I can't tell, we name one buyer.
- Line two: what do they get? We swap every task for the outcome it creates.
- Then the packages. We cut it to three and make the middle one the obvious pick.
- Then the price. We tie it to what the outcome is worth, not to hours.
- Last, the risk. We add one guarantee they can't argue with. Then before and after, side by side.

STORY

[STORY: pick a real offer to tear down, one of your own early offers or a member's with permission, and strip anything private]

ACTION

→ Post your current offer in the community, then post it rebuilt underneath: who, outcome, three packages, price and guarantee.

THE ASSIGNMENT – COURSE 03

Write your offer in one sentence, and your three packages.

Start with the sentence. Use the formula, write ten versions, and read them out loud until one sounds like you talking. Then build three packages under it: a project to get in the door, a core package most people will pick, and a retainer that recurs, each with a name, what's in, what's out, a timeline and a price set on value. Good looks like this: a stranger reads your sentence once and can tell you who it's for and what they get, and you can say every price out loud without flinching.

In the Vault: Proposal Template, Offer worksheet

04

COURSE 04 · WEEK 3 · MONEY IN · 9 LESSONS

MARKETING & LEAD GENERATION

The engine. Everything starts here.

Leads are the engine. When the engine stops, everything else stops with it. This week you build a machine that brings you conversations every week, whether you feel like it or not.

YOU LEAVE WITH A lead machine that brings you conversations every week – whether you feel like it or not.

04.1 LEADS ARE THE WHOLE GAME

04.1

BIG IDEA

Most problems at this stage are a lead problem in disguise. More real conversations fixes most of it.

TALKING POINTS

- When there are no leads, every other problem gets louder. You discount. You keep bad clients. You panic.
- A lead is a real conversation with someone who could buy. Not a like. Not a follower.
- Feast or famine happens because you stop finding work while you're doing work. The fix is to never stop.
- Lead generation is a daily job, like training. You don't do it when you feel like it. You just do it.
- Know your number: how many conversations it takes to get one client. Then have that many, every week.
- If you only fix one thing this month, fix this.

STORY

[STORY: a month the leads dried up because you were busy delivering, and what it cost you]

ACTION

→ Count how many real sales conversations you had in the last 30 days and write the number down. That's your starting point.

04.2 KNOW EXACTLY WHO YOU SELL TO

04.2

BIG IDEA

You can't find your buyer if you can't describe them. Narrow it until you could list a hundred of them by name.

TALKING POINTS

- 'Everyone' is not a market. Nobody can find everyone.
- Write down the job title, the type of company, the size, the location, and the problem keeping them up at night.
- Pick the buyer who has the money and the pain. Not the one who likes you most.
- Sell to the person who signs the check. Not the assistant, not the fan.
- Go narrow first. You can widen later. Narrow is how you get known.
- Here's the test. If you can't list a hundred of them by name, you're either too vague or too narrow.

ACTION

→ Write a one-paragraph buyer profile: title, company type, size, location, the problem, and what they already spend money on to fix it.

04.3 BUILD YOUR LISTS

Where your buyers actually are, and how to reach every one of them.

BIG IDEA

A list is a name, a company and a way to reach them. Build it before you write a single message.

TALKING POINTS

- Your buyers already gather somewhere. Directories, associations, LinkedIn, Google Maps, events, hashtags. Go there.
- Start with who you already know. Past clients, old colleagues, anyone who's bought from you. That's your warmest list.
- Every row needs a name, a company, an email or handle, and a phone number if you can get it.
- The list lives in your CRM. Not in your head, not in a notebook.
- Add to it every week. A list that stops growing is a business that stops growing.
- A hundred real buyers beats ten thousand random names.

ACTION

→ Pick your three best sources and get the first 50 names into your CRM today, starting with people you already know.

04.4 OUTREACH THAT DOESN'T FEEL GROSS

Email, DMs, calls and LinkedIn – what to say and how often.

BIG IDEA

Good outreach is short, about them, and asks for one small thing. Then you follow up until they answer.

TALKING POINTS

- Outreach feels gross when it's about you. Make it about them and it stops feeling gross.
- Four parts. Their name. Something specific you noticed about them. The result you get for people like them. One easy question.
- Ask for a reply, not a meeting. 'Worth a quick chat?' is enough.
- Use every channel. Email, DMs, a call, LinkedIn. Different people answer in different places.
- Plan five touches over two or three weeks before you stop. Most people quit after one.
- Put it on the calendar. A set number of messages, every day, in one block, before you open anything else.

ACTION

→ Write your first message and four follow-ups, then send the first one to 20 people on your list.

04.5 CONTENT THAT TURNS INTO CLIENTS

Proof, not posts.

BIG IDEA

Content that sells shows the result. Before and after, the number, the client saying it. The rest is noise.

TALKING POINTS

- Nobody hires you because you posted. They hire you because they saw proof.
- Proof is the work, the result, and the client saying it. Before and after. The number that moved.

- Every post should make your buyer think 'I want that.' If it doesn't, don't post it.
- Talk to one buyer, the one from your profile. Not to other people in your industry.
- Every piece ends with a next step. Reply, DM, book a call.
- Use your best proof everywhere. One result can be ten posts.

ACTION

→ Pull three results from client work you've already done and turn each one into a post that ends with a clear next step.

04.6 GOING VIRAL ON PURPOSE

What I've learned from going viral many times over.

BIG IDEA

Viral isn't luck. It's a hook, a feeling and a format, and it's only worth it if it points back to your offer.

TALKING POINTS

- I've gone viral many times. It's not luck. It's a pattern you can repeat.
- The first second decides everything. Open with the most surprising thing, not the setup.
- People share what makes them feel something. Surprise, awe, a laugh, 'that's so true.'
- Study what's already working in your space. Take the format, not the content.
- Post a lot. You don't know which one will hit, and volume gives the pattern a chance to work.
- Views don't pay. Every viral piece has to point back to your buyer and your offer, or it's just attention.

STORY

> I've gone viral many times. [STORY: one specific post that went viral: the hook, why it worked, and what it did for the business]

ACTION

→ Find five posts that went big in your space, write down the hook and the format of each, and make one of your own using the strongest one.

04.7 REFERRALS AND WIN-BACKS

The clients you already have are your cheapest leads.

BIG IDEA

The people who already paid you already trust you. Ask them for work and for introductions, on purpose, on a schedule.

TALKING POINTS

- The cheapest lead you'll ever get is from someone who already paid you.
- Ask for referrals at the high point, right after you deliver, when they're happiest.
- Make the ask specific. 'Who else do you know who runs a building like this?' beats 'Know anyone?'
- Win-backs: go through every client who stopped. Send a short note. What's new, and what you'd do for them now.
- Thank every referral. Reward it if it makes sense. People repeat what gets noticed.
- Put it on the calendar. Once a month, every past client hears from you.

ACTION

→ This week, message every past client, ask your happiest current clients for one specific introduction each, and log every reply in your CRM.

04.8 PAID ADS

When to run them – and when you're not ready yet.

BIG IDEA

Ads pour fuel on a fire that's already burning. If your offer doesn't sell from outreach yet, ads just lose money faster.

TALKING POINTS

- Ads don't fix an offer. They make it louder, good or bad.
- You're ready when your offer closes from cold outreach, you know your numbers, and you can deliver for more clients.
- Know what a client is worth before you spend a dollar. That tells you what you can afford to pay for a lead.
- Start small. One audience, one offer, one message. Let it run long enough to learn something.
- Send ads to a conversation, not just a page. A call, a form, a DM.
- Track every dollar to a lead and every lead to a sale. If you can't track it, don't scale it.

ACTION

→ Answer three questions in writing: does my offer close from outreach, what is a client worth, and what can I pay for a lead. If any answer is no or I don't know, don't run ads yet.

04.9 THE WEEKLY LEAD SCOREBOARD

The one number you check every Monday.

BIG IDEA

Pick one lead number, track it every week, and look at it every Monday. What gets counted gets done.

TALKING POINTS

- One number: new conversations started this week. That's it.
- Every Monday, write last week's number and this week's target, and post it in the community.
- Track the inputs too. Messages sent, follow-ups, posts. When the number drops, the inputs tell you why.
- Your target comes from the math: conversations it takes to win a client, times the clients you need.
- If you miss, don't explain it. Fix the inputs and hit it next week.
- This is the number that ends feast or famine. Keep it moving, especially when you're busy.

ACTION

→ Set up a one-line scoreboard with your weekly conversation target and post this Monday's number in the community.

THE ASSIGNMENT – COURSE 04

Build a list of 100 buyers and start 20 conversations.

Write your buyer profile first, so every name on the list fits it. Get the 100 into your CRM with a name, a company and a way to reach them, starting with people you already know, then send your first message and follow up until 20 of them write back. A conversation means they replied, not that you sent. Good looks like 100 real buyers in one place, 20 replies logged with a next step, and your first number posted on the Monday scoreboard.

In the Vault: Why Your Property's Social Isn't Producing Leads (guide), Outreach script pack

05

COURSE 05 · WEEK 4 · MONEY IN · 8 LESSONS

SALES

Help people buy.

Sales is helping someone make a decision that's good for them. This week you get a call script, an answer to every objection, and a follow-up system that closes. Then you go run ten real calls.

YOU LEAVE WITH A call script, an answer to every objection, and a follow-up system that closes.

05.1 SELLING IS HELPING

05.1

BIG IDEA

If your offer really helps, not selling it is the selfish move. Selling is helping the right person decide.

TALKING POINTS

- If you believe in what you sell, you owe it to the right person to help them buy it.
- Pushy is when you care about the sale more than the person. Flip that and the pressure goes away.
- Your job on a call is to find out if you can help. If you can't, say so. That builds more trust than any pitch.
- Nobody needs your excitement. They need your certainty.
- The person who asks the best questions wins the sale.
- Sales is a skill. Like training, you get better with reps, not by thinking about it.

STORY

[STORY: a sale you almost didn't make because you didn't want to seem pushy, and what that client got from saying yes]

ACTION

→ Write down why the right client is better off after buying from you, and read it before every call this week.

05.2 THE DISCOVERY CALL

05.2

BIG IDEA

The discovery call is where they tell you why they need to buy. Ask, listen, and let them say it themselves.

TALKING POINTS

- Open by setting the agenda. 'I'll ask a few questions, and if it's a fit I'll show you how we'd work together. Sound good?'
- Where are you now? Where do you want to be? What's in the way? That's the core of the call.
- Ask what it's costing them to stay where they are, in money and in time.
- Ask why now. If nothing's urgent, nothing gets bought.
- Find out who decides and what the budget is before you present. Not after.
- Talk less than they do. Repeat back what you heard, in their words. Then ask, 'Do you want help fixing that?'

ACTION

→ Put your discovery questions on one page in this order: agenda, now, goal, what's in the way, cost, why now, who decides, budget. Use that page on every call.

05.3 PRESENT THE OFFER AND THE PRICE

Say the number, then stop talking.

BIG IDEA

Tie the offer to what they told you, say the price once, clearly, and then stop talking.

TALKING POINTS

- Present only what solves the problem they told you about. Use their words back to them.
- Walk through the outcome, then how we get there, then the package. In that order.
- Say the number once, clearly, with no apology. Then stop talking.
- The silence after the price is theirs. Don't fill it. Don't add a discount. Don't explain.
- If you have three options, show them and recommend one.
- Practise saying your price out loud until it sounds boring to you.

ACTION

→ Record yourself presenting your core package and saying the price ten times, until you say the number with no pause and no softener.

05.4 OBJECTIONS

Price, timing, “let me think”, “I need to ask my partner.”

BIG IDEA

An objection is a question, not a no. Get the real one on the table and answer it.

TALKING POINTS

- Most objections are a polite way of saying 'I'm not sure yet.' Your job is to find out what they're not sure about.
- Price: ask 'Compared to what?' and bring it back to what the problem is costing them.
- Timing: ask 'What changes between now and then?' Usually nothing does, and the problem keeps costing them.
- “Let me think”: 'Of course. What part do you want to think through? Let's do it now while we're both here.'
- “I need to ask my partner”: 'Makes sense. What do you think they'll ask? Let's get them on a call this week.' Better still, ask who else decides on the discovery call.
- Write down every objection you hear. The same few come up again and again. Script your answer to each one.

ACTION

→ Write your answer to price, timing, “let me think” and “I need to ask my partner”, and say each one out loud before your next call.

05.5 CLOSING

Taking the payment on the call.

BIG IDEA

The close is taking the payment while they're still on the call. If they said yes, help them finish.

TALKING POINTS

- A yes without a payment is a maybe. Take the payment on the call.
- Have the payment link and the contract ready before the call starts.

- When they say yes: 'Great. I'm sending the link now so we can get you started.' Then stay on while they pay.
- Don't celebrate and hang up. Walk them to the next step: the start date, what they need to send, who they'll hear from.
- If they can't pay right now, set the exact time it'll happen and put it on the calendar while you're both on.
- Ask for the sale. A lot of people run a great call and never ask.

ACTION

→ Set up a payment link and a contract for each of your three packages so you can send either one in under a minute on a call.

05.6 FOLLOW-UP

Most deals close after the fifth touch. Most people stop at one.

BIG IDEA

The money is in the follow-up. Build a system so nobody falls through the cracks.

TALKING POINTS

- Most deals close after the fifth touch. Most people stop at one. That gap is your edge.
- Every call ends with a next step and a date. Never 'I'll follow up.' Say when.
- Every lead in your CRM has a stage and a next follow-up date. If it doesn't, it's already lost.
- Every touch adds something. A result, a case study, an answer to their question. Not 'just checking in.'
- Mix the channels. Email, text, a call, a voice note.
- Follow up until you get a yes or a no. A no is fine. Silence is not an answer.

ACTION

→ Go through your CRM, give every open lead a stage and a next follow-up date, and send every overdue follow-up today.

05.7 HIGH-TICKET SALES

Selling $5K, $25K and $100K engagements.

BIG IDEA

Bigger deals aren't harder because of the number. They're harder because the risk and the number of people involved go up. Sell to that.

TALKING POINTS

- As the price goes up, so does the number of people who get a say. One person at the low end. A partner or a boss in the middle. A committee at the top.
- The bigger the number, the more the outcome has to be shown in money. Show the math.
- Find every person who has a say and talk to each of them. Don't let your champion sell it for you.
- Use a proposal. Their problem, the outcome, the plan, the price and the terms, in their words.
- High-ticket buyers are buying certainty. Proof, a clear process, a guarantee, and you staying calm.
- Expect more touches and a longer cycle. Keep a dated next step on it every single time.

STORY

[STORY: your biggest deal: how many people were involved, how long it took, and what finally got it signed]

ACTION

→ Take your biggest open opportunity, write down every person who has a say and what each one cares about, and send a proposal using the Vault template.

05.8 DRILLS: REAL CALLS, BROKEN DOWN

What worked, what didn't, and what to say instead.

BIG IDEA

You get good at sales by reviewing your own calls. Listen back, find where it turned, and fix what you say.

TALKING POINTS

- Record every call, with permission. You can't fix what you can't hear.
- Listen for three moments: when they told you the real problem, when you said the price, and when the objection came.
- Check who talked more. If it was you, that's the first fix.
- For every miss, write the line you'll say instead. Then say it out loud until it's yours.
- We break down real calls here. What worked, what didn't, and what to say instead.
- Bring one call to the live call every week. That's how this gets fast.

STORY

[STORY: a real recorded call, yours or a member's with permission, broken down: the moment it turned and the line that should have been said]

ACTION

→ Record your next call, listen back within 24 hours, and write three things: what worked, what didn't, and what you'll say instead.

THE ASSIGNMENT – COURSE 05

Run ten calls with the script and log every objection you hear.

Run all ten calls off the same discovery page and the same presentation, so you're testing the script, not making it up each time. Record each one, and straight after the call log every objection word for word, what you said back, whether it closed, and the dated next step. After ten, group the objections. You'll see the same few repeat, so rewrite your answer to the top ones. Good looks like ten logged calls, a next step on every open deal, and an objection sheet you'll use on every call after this.

In the Vault: Discovery call script, Objection sheet

06

COURSE 06 · WEEK 5 · THE MACHINE · 7 LESSONS

DELIVERY & CLIENT EXPERIENCE

Keep every client for years.

This is week five. Money's coming in, so now we keep it. This course is about getting the work done on a date, at a standard, without you doing it, and keeping clients for years instead of months.

YOU LEAVE WITH A delivery process with a date on everything – and clients who stay.

06.1 MAKE EVERY CLIENT FEEL LIKE YOUR ONLY CLIENT

06.1

BIG IDEA

Clients don't leave because of the work. They leave because they feel forgotten. Make every one of them feel like the only one, and they stay.

TALKING POINTS

- Every client is quietly asking one question: do they remember me?
- Feeling like the only client isn't about doing more work. It's about attention: names, details, speed.
- Write down what each client cares about, their goals, their people, how they like to hear from you, and read it before every touch.
- Reply fast. Same business day is the floor. Speed tells them they matter.
- The small things carry the most weight. Remember their launch date. Send the result before they ask. Notice their win and say so.
- Build this into the system, not your memory. If it lives in your head, it leaves when you step out.

STORY

[STORY: a client who stayed because of one small thing you remembered]

ACTION

→ For every active client, write one line on what they care about most and how they want to hear from you, and put it in your CRM.

06.2 FROM ORDER TO DELIVERED

06.2

BIG IDEA

Every job follows the same path from the moment they pay to the moment it's delivered. Write the path down, put a date on every step, and the work stops depending on you.

TALKING POINTS

- Start at the moment the money lands. End at the moment the client says got it. Everything in between is your delivery process.
- Most of you have never written this down. It lives in your head, and that's why it breaks when you're busy.
- List every step in order: payment, onboarding, kickoff, production, review, delivery, follow-up.
- Every step gets an owner and a committed date. Not soon. A date.
- Give the client the dates up front. A client who knows what's next doesn't chase you.
- When a step slips, you see it on the map before the client feels it.

STORY

[STORY: a job that went sideways because nobody owned a step]

ACTION

→ Write your delivery steps from payment to delivered, with an owner and a number of days next to each one.

06.3 QUALITY CONTROL WITHOUT DOING IT YOURSELF

Checklists, reviews and the standard.

BIG IDEA

The standard can't live in your eye. Put it on a checklist, build in a review, and someone else can hit it every time.

TALKING POINTS

- If you're the only one who can tell good from bad, you're still the bottleneck.
- Write the standard down. Make it specific enough that two different people would grade the same job the same way.
- Turn it into a checklist the person doing the work runs before they hand it in.
- Add one review by someone other than the person who did the work. Two sets of eyes before the client sees anything.
- When something slips through, don't just fix the job. Fix the checklist so it can't happen again.
- You check the checklist, not every job. Spot-check a few a week and let the system do the rest.

STORY

[STORY: the moment you realized you were checking every job yourself]

ACTION

→ Write a ten-line quality checklist for your main deliverable, and run the next job through it before it reaches you.

06.4 COMMUNICATION THAT KEEPS CLIENTS

Update them before they ask.

BIG IDEA

Update them before they ask. If a client has to chase you, you've already lost some of their trust.

TALKING POINTS

- Silence is where clients start to worry. Worry turns into doubt, and doubt turns into churn.
- Set a rhythm and tell them what it is: a kickoff message, an update at every step, a recap when it's delivered.
- Bad news goes out early, and it comes with a plan. Never let a client find a problem before you tell them.
- Keep updates short: what's done, what's next, and when they'll hear from you again.
- One channel per client. Scattered messages make the business look scattered.
- Template every update so your team sends them, not you.

STORY

[STORY: a client who almost left because they didn't hear from you]

ACTION

→ Write three message templates, kickoff, progress update and delivered, and use them on every active job this week.

06.5 REVISIONS, COMPLAINTS AND SAVING A RELATIONSHIP

Turning an upset client into your biggest fan.

BIG IDEA

An upset client handled well becomes your biggest fan. Listen, own it, fix it fast, and follow up after.

TALKING POINTS

- Set the revision rules before the work starts: how many rounds, what counts as a revision, and what's a new request.
- When a complaint comes in, don't defend. Listen all the way through, then say back what you heard.
- Own your part plainly. We missed that, and here's what we're doing about it. No excuses.
- Fix it faster than they expect. Speed on a problem buys back more trust than the original job earned.
- Follow up once it's fixed and ask if it's right now. That call is where fans are made.
- Then find the cause and change the process, so the next client never sees it.

STORY

[STORY: an upset client who became one of your best]

ACTION

→ Write your revision policy in three sentences and add it to your proposal and your onboarding.

06.6 RETENTION AND CHURN

Why clients leave, and how to keep them.

BIG IDEA

Clients leave for a few predictable reasons. Know them, watch for the signs, and act before the cancellation email.

TALKING POINTS

- Churn is a hole in the bottom of the bucket. You can't market your way out of it.
- Clients leave because they stop seeing results, they feel ignored, something went wrong and wasn't fixed, or they never understood what they were paying for.
- Watch the warning signs: slower replies, skipped calls, questions about the contract, a new decision-maker on their side.
- Show them the result on a schedule. A monthly recap of what you did and what it produced. Make the value visible.
- Hold a review before every renewal. Talk about the next twelve months, not the last invoice.
- Track how long each client stays, and write down why the ones who left, left. That list tells you what to fix.

STORY

[STORY: the client you lost and what it taught you]

ACTION

→ List every client who left in the last year, write the real reason next to each, and fix the most common one this month.

06.7 WALKTHROUGH: CONTRACTS THAT RUN FOR YEARS

How our clients stay 12, 24, 38 months.

BIG IDEA

Our clients stay 12, 24, 38 months because the contract, the delivery and the communication are built for the long run from day one.

TALKING POINTS

- Our clients stay 12, 24, 38 months. That isn't luck. It's built in.
- It starts at the sale: a recurring offer, a contract with a term, and clear expectations on what they get every month.
- Then delivery on a date, every time, at the standard. Consistency is what they're really paying for.
- Then the rhythm: updates before they ask, a monthly recap, and a review before every renewal.
- I'm going to walk you through how we set this up, start to finish, so you can copy it.
- Read the Recurring Client Playbook and the Grove Central white paper in the Vault alongside this lesson.

STORY

> Our clients stay 12, 24, 38 months. [STORY: walk through one long-term client: how they came in, what kept them, and where they are now]

ACTION

→ Write down why your longest client has stayed, then build those reasons into your contract and onboarding for every new client.

THE ASSIGNMENT – COURSE 06

Map your delivery steps and put a committed date on every one.

Start at payment and end at delivered. Write every step in order, then put an owner and a committed date on each one, counted in days from kickoff. Good looks like a one-page map anyone on your team could follow, where the client knows every date before the work starts. If a step has no date, the assignment isn't done.

In the Vault: The Recurring Client Playbook (guide), Grove Central White Paper

07

COURSE 07 · WEEK 6 · THE MACHINE · 6 LESSONS

BUY BACK YOUR TIME

Your hours are the first thing you get back.

Week six. You can't build a business that runs without you while every hour goes into doing the work. This week we find out where your time actually goes, decide what only you should be doing, and hand off the first thing.

YOU LEAVE WITH A list of the only things you should be doing – and your first task handed off.

07.1 WHAT YOUR HOUR IS WORTH

07.1

BIG IDEA

Know what your hour is worth. Anything you can pay someone less than that to do well, you should stop doing.

TALKING POINTS

- Take what you want to earn in a year and divide it by the hours you want to work. That's your hour.
- Now look at your day. How much of it goes to work worth a fraction of that number?
- Every hour on low-value work is an hour not spent selling, building the team, or living your life.
- Doing it yourself to save money is expensive. It costs you the money you'd make with that hour.
- Write your number down. You'll use it to decide every handoff from here.

STORY

[STORY: when you realized you were doing work worth far less than your time]

ACTION

→ Calculate your hourly number from your target and write it at the top of your time audit.

07.2 THE TIME AUDIT

07.2

BIG IDEA

You can't buy back time you haven't measured. Track one full week, honestly, in thirty-minute blocks.

TALKING POINTS

- For one week, write down what you do in thirty-minute blocks. All of it. Email, calls, edits, scrolling.
- Write it as you go, not at the end of the day. Memory lies.
- Tag each block: does it make money, does it run the business, or does it just keep you busy?
- Then mark the value. Is this worth your hourly number, or could someone else do it for far less?
- At the end of the week, add it up. Most people are shocked by how little time goes to the work only they can do.

STORY

[STORY: what your own first time audit showed you]

ACTION

→ Start your time audit today: thirty-minute blocks for seven days, every block tagged.

07.3 THE ONLY THINGS YOU SHOULD BE DOING

Everything else is a candidate to hand off.

BIG IDEA

Only a short list of things belongs on your plate. Everything else is a candidate to hand off.

TALKING POINTS

- At this stage your job is short: selling, setting the standard, hiring the right people, and deciding where the company goes.
- Everything else is a candidate to hand off. Not someday. Now.
- Sort your audit into four groups: only you can do it, someone could do it with training, someone could do it today, and nobody should be doing it.
- Kill the last group first. Then hand off what someone could do today.
- If you love doing the work, keep it as a choice, not a requirement. The business can't depend on it.

ACTION

→ Write the list of the only things you should be doing, five items at most, and pin it where you work.

07.4 YOUR FIRST HANDOFF

The task that gives you back the most hours.

BIG IDEA

Hand off the repeatable task that gives you back the most hours. One task handed off properly beats ten half-delegated.

TALKING POINTS

- Look at your audit and find the task that repeats and eats the most hours. That's your first handoff.
- Record yourself doing it once, screen and voice. That recording is the first draft of the training.
- Write what done looks like and when it's due. Outcome, standard, deadline.
- Have them do it while you check. Then have them do it without you.
- It will be worse at first. That's the price. Correct it, update the checklist, and don't take it back.
- Count the hours you get back every week. That number is your proof.

STORY

[STORY: the first thing you ever handed off, and how it went]

ACTION

→ Pick your biggest repeatable task, record yourself doing it once, and hand it to someone by the end of the week.

07.5 TOOLS AND AI THAT BUY BACK HOURS THIS WEEK

The fastest wins, no team required.

BIG IDEA

Before you hire, automate. The fastest hours you'll get back come from tools you can set up this week.

TALKING POINTS

- Not every handoff needs a person. Some need a tool.
- Start with scheduling. A booking link instead of back-and-forth emails.
- Then payments. A payment link and automatic invoices instead of chasing money.
- Use AI for first drafts: proposals, emails, captions, recaps. You edit. You never start from blank.
- Make a template for every message you send more than twice.

- Never automate the relationship. Tools take the admin. Keep the human where it counts.

ACTION

→ Pick three repeated admin tasks from your audit and set up a tool, template or AI prompt for each one this week.

07.6 PROTECT THE TIME YOU WIN BACK

Or it fills right back up.

BIG IDEA

Time you win back fills right back up unless you decide in advance where it goes.

TALKING POINTS

- Hours you free up don't stay free. They fill with something worse unless you protect them.
- Decide what the time is for before you win it back: selling, hiring, training, or your life.
- Put it on the calendar as a block and treat it like a client meeting.
- Watch for work creeping back. If a task you handed off lands on your desk again, hand it back.
- Say no more. Every yes to something small is a no to something that matters.
- Run the time audit again every quarter. It drifts.

STORY

[STORY: what you do with the hours you've won back, and how you guard them]

ACTION

→ Block the hours you've won back on your calendar for the next four weeks, and write what each block is for.

THE ASSIGNMENT – COURSE 07

Track one week, then hand off your biggest repeatable task.

Track every thirty-minute block for seven days, as you go, and tag each one by value. At the end of the week, rank the tasks by hours spent and how often they repeat. The top one is your handoff. Good looks like a full week with no gaps, a clear number of hours you'll get back, and that task handed off with a recording and a definition of done before next week's call.

In the Vault: Time audit sheet

08

COURSE 08 · WEEK 7 · THE MACHINE · 7 LESSONS

RECRUITING & HIRING

Talent is the business.

Week seven. Talent is the business. You can have the best offer and the best systems and still be stuck if the wrong people are doing the work. This week you build a hiring process that finds good people on demand, so nobody, including you, is irreplaceable.

YOU LEAVE WITH A hiring process that finds good people on demand – and a bench, so nobody is irreplaceable.

08.1 TALENT IS THE BUSINESS

08.1

BIG IDEA

Your business will never be better than the people doing the work. Hiring isn't a side task. It is the job.

TALKING POINTS

- Your business is only as good as the people doing the work.
- I built my own companies and trained the people who now run them. That's the only reason I can step away.
- Hiring isn't something you do when you're desperate. It's a process you run all the time.
- The right person makes you money. The wrong person costs you clients, time and reputation.
- Your job is to find people better than you at the work and give them a standard to hit.

STORY

> I built my own companies and trained the people who now run them. [STORY: your first great hire and what changed after]

ACTION

→ List every role in your business today and who does it, then circle every role where the answer is you.

08.2 CONTRACTORS OR EMPLOYEES

08.2

BIG IDEA

Start with contractors for the work. Move to employees when a role is full-time, core to the business, and needs you directing how it's done.

TALKING POINTS

- Contractors are paid for the output. Employees are paid for their time, and you direct how they work.
- Early on, contractors make sense. You pay per job, scale up and down, and test before you commit.
- Move to an employee when the role is full-time, core to the business, and you need to direct how and when the work gets done.
- The rules on who counts as a contractor are different in every country and state. Get it checked by an accountant or attorney. Don't guess.
- Whichever you choose, the standard is the same. Same checklist, same deadlines, same expectations.

ACTION

→ For each role you'll fill in the next 90 days, write contractor or employee and why, then confirm it with your accountant.

08.3 WHERE TO FIND GOOD PEOPLE

Anywhere in the world.

BIG IDEA

Good people are anywhere in the world. Go where they already show their work.

TALKING POINTS

- If the work can be done remotely, you're not limited to your city. The whole world is your pool.
- Look where people show their work: portfolios, industry communities, freelance platforms and social.
- Referrals from people you trust are the fastest filter. Ask your best people who they'd hire.
- Post the role where your kind of person already spends time, not just on a job board.
- Always be looking. The best time to find someone is before you need them.

ACTION

→ Pick three places your ideal hire already shows their work, and save ten candidates from them this week.

08.4 THE POST, THE SCREEN, THE PAID TRIAL

Test the work before you commit.

BIG IDEA

Test the work before you commit. A clear post, a fast screen and a paid trial tell you more than any interview.

TALKING POINTS

- The post says what the role is, what done looks like, what it pays, and how to apply. Put one specific instruction in it so you can see who actually reads.
- The screen is a short call or a few written questions. You're checking communication, reliability and fit. Not charm.
- The paid trial is a real piece of work, with a deadline and your checklist. Same as the actual job.
- Always pay for the trial. It's fair, and it brings out the serious people.
- Watch everything. Did they hit the deadline, ask good questions, follow the standard? That's how they'll work for you.

ACTION

→ Write your job post with one instruction buried in it, and design a paid trial that matches the real job.

08.5 SCORE AND CHOOSE

Hire slow, let go fast.

BIG IDEA

Hire slow, let go fast. Score every candidate on the same criteria and decide on evidence, not on feeling.

TALKING POINTS

- Hire slow, let go fast.
- Build a simple scorecard before you see a single candidate: quality of work, hit the deadline, communication, followed the standard, attitude.
- Score every trial the same way, one to five, with a sentence of evidence next to every score.
- Choose on the numbers. If you're talking yourself into someone, the answer is no.

- Start every hire on a trial period with clear targets. If they miss and don't improve, let them go fast. Waiting only makes it worse.

STORY

[STORY: a hire you made on gut feeling and what it cost you]

ACTION

→ Build a five-line scorecard and score every paid trial on it before you choose.

08.6 ONBOARDING AND PROTECTING YOUR BUSINESS

NDAs, agreements and access.

BIG IDEA

A good first week makes a good hire stick. The paperwork and the access rules protect you if it doesn't.

TALKING POINTS

- Before anyone starts: a signed agreement, an NDA, and clear terms on who owns the work.
- Have an attorney look at your agreements once. Then use them every single time.
- Give access only to what they need. Their own logins, never yours. Shared passwords are a risk.
- Their first week: your SOPs, your checklist, one small real job, and a check-in at the end of it.
- Keep a list of everything each person has access to, so you can shut it off in one afternoon if you need to.

ACTION

→ Put together your onboarding pack, agreement, NDA, access list and first-week plan, before your next hire starts.

08.7 KEEP A BENCH

Five good people ready for every role, at all times.

BIG IDEA

Five good people ready for every role, at all times. Nobody is irreplaceable, including you.

TALKING POINTS

- Five good people ready for every role, at all times.
- Everyone who did well on a trial but didn't get the role goes on the bench. Stay in touch.
- Give bench people small paid jobs now and then, so they know your standard and you know they're still good.
- When someone leaves or work spikes, you call the bench. No panic, no scramble.
- A bench keeps the standard high. When nobody is irreplaceable, nobody gets to coast.

STORY

[STORY: a time someone left and you had nobody ready]

ACTION

→ Start a bench list for your most important role and get it to five names.

THE ASSIGNMENT – COURSE 08

Write one job post and run three paid trials.

Write one post for the role you need most, with the pay, what done looks like, and one instruction that tests who reads. Run three paid trials on the same real task, with the same deadline and the same checklist. Score all three on your scorecard and write the evidence down. Good looks like a hire you'd choose on the numbers alone, and two strong runners-up who go straight onto your bench.

In the Vault: Job post + paid trial template

09

COURSE 09 · WEEK 8 · THE MACHINE · 6 LESSONS

DELEGATION & SYSTEMS

If it lives in your head, it isn't a system.

This week we take everything out of your head and put it where other people can use it. If the business only works when you remember things, you don't have a business, you have a memory. By Friday you'll have your three most repeated jobs written down so someone else can run them.

YOU LEAVE WITH SOPs for your core work, a CRM that runs the company, and work that moves without you.

09.1 IF IT'S IN YOUR HEAD, IT ISN'T A SYSTEM

09.1

BIG IDEA

Anything that only works because you remember it will break the day you stop remembering. A system is something another person can run, the same way, without asking you.

TALKING POINTS

- Every time someone asks you how to do something, that's proof it isn't written down.
- Your memory is the most expensive storage in the company, because it only works when you're awake and in the room.
- A system has three parts: the steps, the standard for done, and where it lives so anyone can find it.
- You don't need to systemize everything. Start with the work you repeat every week.
- The test is simple. Could someone new do this job tomorrow, from the document alone, and get it right? If not, it isn't a system yet.

STORY

[STORY: a time something broke because it only lived in your head]

ACTION

→ For the next three days, write down every question anyone asks you about how something is done. That list is your first set of SOPs.

09.2 WRITE AN SOP IN 30 MINUTES

09.2

BIG IDEA

An SOP doesn't need to be perfect. It needs to exist, be short, and get better every time someone uses it.

TALKING POINTS

- Don't write it from a blank page. Record yourself doing the job once, screen and voice, then turn the recording into steps.
- Every SOP has the same shape: what this is for, when it happens, who owns it, the steps, and what done looks like.
- Write each step as one action. Start it with a verb. If a step has an 'and' in it, it's two steps.
- Put the standard in writing. 'Edit the video' is not a standard. 'Under 60 seconds, captions on, logo in the last frame' is.
- Hand it to the person who'll do the job and let them run it while you watch. Every place they get stuck, fix the document, not the person.

- Set a timer for 30 minutes. When it goes off, the SOP is done. Version two comes from real use.

ACTION

→ Pick one job you do every week. Record yourself doing it, then write the SOP from the recording in 30 minutes using the SOP template.

09.3 THE CRM

One place for every lead, client, job and dollar – the setup we run on.

BIG IDEA

One place for every lead, client, job and dollar. If it isn't in the CRM, it didn't happen.

TALKING POINTS

- A CRM is not a contact list. It's the place the whole company runs from.
- At minimum you need four things in it: people, deals, jobs and money. Leads come in, become deals, become jobs, become paid invoices.
- Every deal has a stage. Every job has an owner and a date. Every invoice has a status. That's how you see the business without asking anyone.
- Pick one tool and move everything into it. Two systems means nobody trusts either one.
- The rule for the team is simple: if it isn't in the CRM, it didn't happen.
- Start simple. You can add fields later. You can't fix a CRM nobody uses.

STORY

[SHOW: screen-share the CRM we run on, from a new lead to a paid invoice]

ACTION

→ Set up your CRM with four tables or sections: people, deals, jobs and money. Move every open lead and every active client into it this week.

09.4 DELEGATE SO IT STICKS

Outcome, standard, deadline, check-in.

BIG IDEA

Outcome, standard, deadline, check-in. Miss one of the four and the work comes back to you.

TALKING POINTS

- Most delegation fails because the owner hands off a task, not an outcome. Tell them what the finished result is, not just what to do.
- Then give them the standard. Show them what good looks like. Point to the SOP or an example.
- Then the deadline. A date and a time, not 'when you get a chance'.
- Then the check-in. Agree when you'll look at it before it's due, so problems show up early, not on the deadline.
- When the work comes back wrong, don't take it back and do it yourself. Show them the gap against the standard and let them fix it.
- If you redo their work, you've just taught them that you'll always redo their work.

STORY

[STORY: a handoff that came back to you, and which of the four was missing]

ACTION

→ Delegate one task this week using all four: write the outcome, the standard, the deadline and the check-in time in one message, and send it.

09.5 THE MACHINE

People, process, tools and AI, working together.

BIG IDEA

People, process, tools and AI, working together. Each one does the job it's best at, and none of them depend on you.

TALKING POINTS

- People do the work that needs judgement, taste and relationships.
- Process tells the people exactly how it's done, so the result is the same no matter who does it.
- Tools hold the information and move it along: the CRM, the calendar, the payment link, the shared drive.
- AI takes the repeatable writing, sorting and first drafts, so your people spend their time on what matters.
- When something breaks, ask which of the four failed. Most of the time it isn't the person, it's a missing process.
- Your job is to build and tune the machine, not to be a part inside it.

ACTION

→ Take one service you sell and map it on one page: who does each step, which SOP covers it, which tool it lives in, and where AI can do the first draft.

09.6 WALKTHROUGH: THE OPERATING SYSTEM BEHIND MY AGENCY

How a national company runs without me in the room.

BIG IDEA

How a national company runs without me in the room. It's not talent or luck. It's the same SOPs, CRM and rhythm you're building this week.

TALKING POINTS

- I'm going to show you the actual operating system, not a diagram of it.
- Watch how a lead comes in, gets worked, becomes a client, gets delivered and gets paid, and notice where I'm not involved.
- Every job has an owner, a date and a standard. That's why nobody needs to call me.
- The team doesn't ask me how to do things. They check the SOP, and if the SOP is wrong, they fix it.
- None of this was built in one go. It was built one SOP and one handoff at a time.

STORY

> A national agency runs without me in the room. [SHOW: walk through the operating system end to end, from lead to paid] [STORY: the first time you saw it run without you]

ACTION

→ Compare your business to the walkthrough. Write down the three places where work still stops and waits for you. Those are your next three SOPs.

THE ASSIGNMENT – COURSE 09

Write SOPs for your three most repeated jobs.

Pick your three most repeated jobs, the ones you or your team do every single week. Record yourself doing each one once, then write each SOP in 30 minutes: purpose, owner, trigger, steps, and what done looks like. Hand each SOP to the person who'll run it and fix the document every

time they get stuck. Good looks like someone else completing all three jobs this week, from the document alone, without asking you a single question.

In the Vault: SOP template, CRM template

10

COURSE 10 · WEEK 9 · THE MACHINE · 7 LESSONS

LEADERSHIP & MANAGING A TEAM

From doing the work to leading it.

You've got people now. This week is about leading them, not doing their job for them. We'll set the standard, build a weekly rhythm, and get you ready to hand the keys to your first manager.

YOU LEAVE WITH Standards your team holds without you, a weekly rhythm, and your first manager.

10.1 FROM DOER TO LEADER

10.1

BIG IDEA

Your job is no longer to do the work. Your job is to make sure the work gets done to the standard, without you.

TALKING POINTS

- The skills that got you here, doing the work fast and well, are now what's holding the business back.
- Every time you jump in and do it yourself, you take the rep away from your team.
- A leader's output is the team's output. Measure yourself by what they ship, not what you ship.
- This feels slower at first. It is slower at first. Then it's the only way to get faster.
- Your new work is setting the standard, hiring, training, removing roadblocks and keeping score.

STORY

[STORY: the moment you realized doing the work yourself was the bottleneck]

ACTION

→ List everything you did last week. Mark each item 'doer' or 'leader'. Pick one doer item and hand it off this week.

10.2 SET THE STANDARD, AND HOLD IT

10.2

BIG IDEA

The standard is whatever you tolerate. Write it down, show it, and hold it every single time.

TALKING POINTS

- If it isn't written, it isn't a standard. It's a mood.
- Show people what good looks like with real examples, not adjectives.
- You set the standard by what you let slide. Let it slide once and that's the new standard.
- Hold it the same way for everyone, every time. Consistency is what makes people trust it.
- Hold yourself to it first. The team watches what you do, not what you say. That's what the Marine Corps taught me about showing up.
- When the standard is clear, you don't have to be the bad guy. The standard does the talking.

STORY

[STORY: a time you let the standard slip, and what it cost]

ACTION

→ Write the standard for your core deliverable in one page with two examples of good and one of not good enough. Share it with the team.

10.3 THE WEEKLY RHYTHM

Meetings, scoreboards and check-ins.

BIG IDEA

Meetings, scoreboards and check-ins. One weekly meeting and one scoreboard will fix most of your team problems.

TALKING POINTS

- A team without a rhythm runs on interruptions. A team with a rhythm runs on a calendar.
- One weekly team meeting, same day, same time, same agenda. Keep it short.
- The agenda: the scoreboard, wins, what's stuck, and who owns what by when.
- The scoreboard is three to five numbers that tell you if the week went well. Leads, sales, jobs delivered on time, cash collected.
- Short one-on-ones with each direct report catch problems before they turn into fires.
- If something can wait for the weekly meeting, it waits for the weekly meeting.

ACTION

→ Book your weekly team meeting as a recurring event and pick the three to five numbers that go on your scoreboard.

10.4 ACCOUNTABILITY WITHOUT MICROMANAGING

Trust, with a scoreboard.

BIG IDEA

Trust, with a scoreboard. You don't watch people work. You watch the numbers and the standard.

TALKING POINTS

- Micromanaging is what happens when you don't have a scoreboard.
- Give people ownership of an outcome and a number, then leave them alone to hit it.
- Every task has one owner and one date. Two owners means no owner.
- When a number is off, ask questions first. What happened, what's the plan, what do you need from me.
- Follow up on every commitment. If you don't check, people learn it doesn't matter.
- Trust is earned by hitting the numbers. Give more room to the people who keep hitting them.

ACTION

→ Give each person on your team one number they own and put it on the scoreboard with their name next to it.

10.5 HARD CONVERSATIONS

Feedback, letting people go, and doing it well.

BIG IDEA

Feedback, letting people go, and doing it well. The conversation you're avoiding is costing you more than the conversation itself.

TALKING POINTS

- Give feedback early, in private, and about the work, not the person.
- Be specific. Say what happened, what the standard is, and what needs to change by when.
- Don't stack up problems and unload them all at once. Small and often beats big and late.
- Hire slow, let go fast. If you've given clear feedback and it isn't changing, it's time.
- When you let someone go, be direct, be kind, and be brief. Thank them, keep their dignity intact, and cut access the same day.

- Everyone else on the team already knows who isn't pulling their weight. They're waiting to see if you do.

STORY

[STORY: a hard conversation you put off too long]

ACTION

→ Name the one conversation you've been avoiding. Write down what happened, the standard, and what needs to change, then have it this week.

10.6 YOUR FIRST MANAGER

Who, when, and how to hand them the keys.

BIG IDEA

Who, when, and how to hand them the keys. Your first manager is the person who takes the day-to-day off your plate.

TALKING POINTS

- You need a manager when you're the one answering every question and approving every job.
- Look inside first. The best first manager is usually someone who already holds the standard without being told.
- Don't promote your best doer just because they're the best doer. Promote the person others already go to.
- Hand over in steps. First they run the weekly meeting. Then they own the scoreboard. Then they own hiring and handoffs.
- Give them the authority to make calls, not just the responsibility. And don't overrule them in front of the team.
- Your job becomes coaching one person instead of managing everyone.

STORY

[STORY: choosing your first manager, and what you'd do differently]

ACTION

→ Write down who your first manager is, or will be, and the first thing you'll hand them: running the weekly meeting.

10.7 LEADING A REMOTE TEAM

Culture when nobody's in the same room.

BIG IDEA

Culture when nobody's in the same room. Remote works when everything is written, everything is scheduled, and the standard is visible.

TALKING POINTS

- Remote teams run on writing. If it isn't in the CRM, the SOP or the chat, it didn't happen.
- Keep the rhythm sacred. The weekly meeting matters more when nobody shares an office.
- Cameras on for the team meeting. You need to see people, and they need to see you.
- Default to async for updates and keep live time for decisions and problems.
- Hire people anywhere in the world, and judge them on output, not hours online.
- Culture is what you celebrate and what you tolerate. Post the wins publicly and handle the misses privately.

STORY

I walked my brother from wanting a company to running one fully remote at six figures a month.

ACTION

→ Move all team updates into one written channel and post the scoreboard there every week before the meeting.

THE ASSIGNMENT – COURSE 10

Set one weekly team meeting and one scoreboard.

Book one recurring weekly team meeting, same day and time, and put it on everyone's calendar. Build one scoreboard with three to five numbers, each with one owner's name next to it. Run the first meeting with a fixed agenda: scoreboard, wins, what's stuck, and who owns what by when. Good looks like a meeting that ends on time with every open item owned and dated, and a scoreboard the team can read without you explaining it.

In the Vault: Weekly meeting agenda

11

COURSE 11 · WEEK 10 · STEP OUT · 7 LESSONS

MONEY

Revenue targets and the numbers.

This week we get honest about the numbers. Most owners don't know their margin, their cash or how many leads it takes to hit their month. By Friday you'll have a target, and the weekly lead number it takes to get there.

YOU LEAVE WITH A revenue target broken down into weekly actions – and numbers you actually understand.

11.1 SET THE TARGET

11.1

BIG IDEA

Pick a monthly revenue number and a date. A target without a date is a wish.

TALKING POINTS

- Start with the life you want and work out what it costs. That's the floor for your number.
- Pick one monthly revenue number. Not a range. One number.
- Put a date on it. The month you'll hit it for the first time.
- Make it big enough to change how you work, and close enough that you'll still believe it next month.
- Write it where you'll see it every day, and post it in the community.

STORY

[STORY: the first revenue target you set, and what happened]

ACTION

→ Write your monthly revenue target and the date you'll hit it. Post both in the community.

11.2 WORK IT BACKWARDS

11.2

BIG IDEA

Every revenue target breaks down into a weekly number of leads and conversations. Do the math once and you'll know exactly what to do every Monday.

TALKING POINTS

- Start with the target. Divide it by your average client value per month. That's how many clients you need.
- Then use your close rate. If you close one in four calls, you need four calls for every client.
- Then your show-up and booking rate. How many conversations does it take to book one call?
- Then divide by the weeks. That gives you the weekly lead number.
- Here's the shape of it: target, divided by client value, times calls per close, times leads per call, divided by weeks. Plug in your own numbers.
- If you don't know your close rate yet, use your last ten calls. Real numbers beat guesses.

ACTION

→ Fill in the revenue target calculator with your real numbers and write down your weekly lead number.

11.3 THE NUMBERS EVERY OWNER KNOWS

Revenue, margin, cash and pipeline.

BIG IDEA

Revenue, margin, cash and pipeline. If you can't say these four from memory, you're guessing.

TALKING POINTS

- Revenue is what you billed this month. Not what you hope to bill.
- Margin is what's left after you pay for the work. That's the money that runs the business.
- Cash is what's actually in the bank, and what's coming in and going out in the next 30 days.
- Pipeline is the open deals and what they're worth. It tells you what next month looks like.
- Check all four every week. It takes ten minutes once your CRM and books are set up.
- Profit on paper doesn't pay bills. Cash does.

ACTION

→ Write down your revenue, margin, cash and pipeline as of today. If you can't find one, that's the first thing to fix.

11.4 MARGINS

Charge on value, pay the market rate.

BIG IDEA

Charge on value, pay the market rate. Your margin lives in the gap between the two.

TALKING POINTS

- Price on what the result is worth to the client, not on your hours or your costs.
- Pay the people who do the work a fair market rate for that work.
- The gap between the two is your margin, and your margin funds sales, management, growth and your own pay.
- If your margin is thin, you have a pricing problem or a delivery problem. Usually pricing.
- This is how I charge ten times the market and hold it. The client pays for the outcome, and the delivery cost is set by the market.
- Know your margin on every package. If one package doesn't make money, fix it or kill it.

STORY

[STORY: the first time you raised your price]

ACTION

→ Work out the margin on each of your packages: price minus the cost to deliver it. Flag any package below the margin you need.

11.5 CASH, BILLS AND PAYING YOURSELF

Know what's coming, and when.

BIG IDEA

Know what's coming, and when. Cash problems are almost always timing problems you didn't see coming.

TALKING POINTS

- Keep a simple cash calendar: what's coming in, what's going out, and on what date, for the next 30 days.
- Get paid up front or on a schedule. Recurring contracts make cash predictable.
- Invoice the day the work is delivered, not when you remember.

- Know your fixed bills every month: payroll, contractors, software, rent. No surprises.
- Pay yourself on a set amount and a set date. If the business can't pay you, that's information, not a reason to skip it quietly.
- Chase overdue invoices every week. Money owed to you is not money you have.

ACTION

→ Build a 30-day cash calendar listing every payment in and every bill out, with dates. Set the date and amount you pay yourself.

11.6 ORGANIZE THE MONEY

Accounts, books and peace of mind.

BIG IDEA

Accounts, books and peace of mind. Separate accounts, clean books every month, and nobody guesses.

TALKING POINTS

- Business money and personal money never live in the same account.
- Set up separate accounts so you can see at a glance what's for operating, what's for taxes, and what's for profit.
- Get the books done every month, not once a year. A bookkeeper is one of the first hires that pays for itself.
- Set aside tax money every time you get paid, so tax time isn't a crisis.
- Keep every invoice and every receipt in one place your bookkeeper can reach.
- Clean books are what let you make decisions fast, and what let you sell the business one day.

ACTION

→ Open separate accounts for operating and taxes if you don't have them, and book a monthly close with your bookkeeper.

11.7 HIT THE NUMBER EVERY MONTH

The monthly scoreboard.

BIG IDEA

The monthly scoreboard. Check the number every week, so the end of the month is never a surprise.

TALKING POINTS

- Put the monthly target, the weekly lead number, closed revenue to date and pipeline on one scoreboard.
- Look at it every Monday. If you're behind in week two, you still have time to fix it.
- When you're behind, go back to the lead number. It's almost always a leads problem.
- At the end of the month, write down what you hit, what you missed and why. One line each.
- Then set next month's target. Same process, every month.
- Hitting the number once is good. Hitting it every month is a business.

ACTION

→ Build your monthly scoreboard with target, weekly lead number, revenue closed and pipeline, and review it every Monday this month.

THE ASSIGNMENT – COURSE 11

Write your target and the weekly lead number it takes to hit it.

Start with your monthly target and the date. Then work it backwards with your real numbers: average client value, close rate from your last ten calls, and how many conversations it takes to book one call. Divide down to a weekly lead number and write it next to the target. Good looks like one line you can read every Monday, the target, the date and the number of leads it takes each week, built on real data, not hope.

In the Vault: Revenue target calculator

12

COURSE 12 · WEEK 11 · STEP OUT · 7 LESSONS

GET OUT OF THE WORK

Replace yourself, one role at a time.

This is the week you start replacing yourself. Not all at once. One role at a time, in a set order, until the business runs from your phone and you're the owner, not the operator.

YOU LEAVE WITH A plan to replace yourself role by role – and a business you can run from your phone.

12.1 A FINISHED BUSINESS HAS A DEFINITION

12.1

BIG IDEA

A finished business is one you can leave, sell, or run from your phone on the other side of the world, and it holds. If it can't do that yet, it isn't finished. It's a job you own.

TALKING POINTS

- Most owners never finish their business because they never defined what finished means.
- Here's the definition: you can leave it, sell it, or run it from your phone anywhere, and revenue, delivery and clients all hold.
- Test it honestly. If you disappeared for thirty days, what breaks first? That's what you work on.
- Finished doesn't mean you stop working. It means the business doesn't need you to work.
- Time freedom, location freedom and financial freedom aren't the reward at the end. They're the spec you build to.
- Everything else in this course is just closing the gap between where you are and that definition.

STORY

[STORY: the moment you realized one of your businesses was finished – the first time it held without you]

ACTION

→ Write the thirty-day test: list what would break in your business if you vanished for thirty days, in the order it would break.

12.2 THE REPLACEMENT MAP

12.2

BIG IDEA

Every hat you wear is a role someone else can hold. The replacement map lists each one, who takes it, and the date you hand it over.

TALKING POINTS

- Write down every role you play in the business. Not tasks, roles: delivery, sales, hiring, client communication, operations, finance.
- Next to each role, write how many hours a week it takes you and what it costs to replace.
- Then write who takes it. A name if you have one, a job post if you don't.
- Then a date. A role without a handoff date is a wish, not a plan.
- The order matters: delivery first, then sales, then management. That's the order I'll teach this week.
- When the map has a name and a date next to every role except owner, you have a plan to get out.

ACTION

→ Build your replacement map: every role, hours per week, who replaces you, and the handoff date.

12.3 STEP OUT OF DELIVERY FIRST

The work goes before anything else.

BIG IDEA

The work goes before anything else. Delivery is the easiest role to systemize and the one eating most of your hours.

TALKING POINTS

- Delivery is first because it's the most repeatable thing you do, and repeatable means it can be written down.
- If you're still doing the work, you have no time to sell, hire or lead. Everything stalls behind it.
- Use what you already built: your delivery map from Course 06, your SOPs from Course 09, your bench from Course 08.
- Hand it off in stages. They shadow you, then you shadow them, then you only review, then you stop reviewing.
- Quality holds because of the checklist and the standard, not because your hands are on it.
- Your clients bought the outcome, not you doing the task. Deliver the outcome and they won't miss you in the work.

STORY

[STORY: the first job you didn't do yourself, and what it felt like to let it go]

ACTION

→ Pick the delivery role you'll hand off first, name the person, and run the first shadow job this week.

12.4 THEN SALES

Train someone to sell it like you do.

BIG IDEA

Train someone to sell it like you do. Selling is a skill with a script, not a personality trait only you have.

TALKING POINTS

- Sales comes second because you can't train someone to sell what you can't yet deliver without you.
- Most owners think nobody can sell like them. That's usually because they never wrote down how they sell.
- Give them the script, the objection sheet and recordings of your best calls from Course 05.
- They listen to you, then they run calls while you listen, then they run calls alone and you review the recordings.
- Pay on results. A base plus commission keeps the incentive where it belongs.
- Watch the close rate, not the vibe. If the numbers hold, the handoff worked.

STORY

[STORY: training the first person to sell your offer – what you had to unlearn about thinking only you could do it]

ACTION

→ Record your next three sales calls and build them into a training pack with your script and objection sheet.

12.5 THEN MANAGEMENT

Hand over the operation.

BIG IDEA

Hand over the operation. The last role to go is the one running the day, and it goes to a manager who holds your standard.

TALKING POINTS

- Management is last because a manager needs systems to manage. Without delivery and sales handed off, there's nothing to run.
- Your first manager is usually someone already on the team who holds the standard when you're not looking.
- Hand them the keys in writing: what they decide alone, what they bring to you, and what they never touch.
- They run the weekly meeting and own the scoreboard. You show up as a guest, then you stop showing up.
- Your job changes to one weekly check on the numbers and one conversation with your manager.
- If you keep stepping back in to fix things, you didn't hand over the operation. You loaned it.

ACTION

→ Write the decision list for your manager: what they decide alone, what comes to you, and what is off limits.

12.6 RUN IT REMOTE

From your phone, from anywhere.

BIG IDEA

From your phone, from anywhere. If you can see the numbers and reach your manager, you can run the company.

TALKING POINTS

- Running it remote isn't about where you sit. It's about whether the business needs you physically present to work.
- Everything lives in the CRM. Every lead, client, job and dollar. If it's not in there, it doesn't exist.
- Your phone holds three things: the scoreboard, the team channel and your calendar. That's the whole office.
- Check the scoreboard daily. Talk to your manager weekly. Act only when a number moves the wrong way.
- A national agency runs without me in the room. That only works because the system holds, not because I check in all day.
- Test it. Run a week from somewhere else and write down every time you had to step in. Those are your next fixes.

STORY

> A national agency runs without me in the room.

ACTION

→ Run three working days entirely from your phone and log every moment you had to step in.

12.7 WALKTHROUGH: HOW I HANDED A COMPANY TO MY BROTHER

Four steps – the work, the selling, the hiring, the operation.

BIG IDEA

Four steps – the work, the selling, the hiring, the operation. The same order you're running this week, done for real.

TALKING POINTS

- I walked my brother from wanting a company to running one fully remote at six figures a month. This is how I handed it over.
- Step one was the work. He learned to deliver it, then to get it delivered by someone else.
- Step two was the selling. He learned the script and ran the calls until the numbers held without me.
- Step three was the hiring. He learned to find good people, run paid trials and keep a bench.
- Step four was the operation. The meetings, the scoreboard, the decisions. That's when it became his.
- The order is the lesson. Skip a step and you end up back in the business.

STORY

I handed a company to my brother in four steps: the work, the selling, the hiring, the operation. [STORY: the details of each step – what was hardest for him, and the moment you knew it was his]

ACTION

→ Mark where you are on the four steps – the work, the selling, the hiring, the operation – and write the next handoff on your calendar.

THE ASSIGNMENT – COURSE 12

Build your replacement map and hand off the first role this month.

Build your replacement map first: every role you hold, the hours it takes, who replaces you and a handoff date. Don't skip the hours column, because that's how you see which handoff buys back the most. Then hand off the first role this month, which for almost everyone is a piece of delivery. Good looks like a named person doing that role this month, with an SOP and a checklist, and you reviewing the result instead of doing the work. Post your map in the community.

In the Vault: Replacement map

13

COURSE 13 · WEEK 12 · STEP OUT · 7 LESSONS

SCALE

The same machine, bigger.

Scale is the same machine, bigger. You don't need ten new ideas. You need to find the one thing holding your growth and break it, then do it again.

YOU LEAVE WITH The one constraint holding your growth – and the move that breaks it.

13.1 FIND THE ONE CONSTRAINT

13.1

BIG IDEA

Your business only grows as fast as its tightest point. Find that one constraint and work on nothing else until it breaks.

TALKING POINTS

- Every business has one constraint at a time. Not five. One.
- Go back to the ten problems: leads, marketing, sales, retention, churn, recruiting, delegation, managing, leadership, scaling. Which one is yours right now?
- Read your scoreboard. The constraint is the number that's flat while everything around it is ready to grow.
- If you have more leads than you can close, it's sales. If you close more than you can deliver, it's delivery or hiring.
- Fixing anything other than the constraint feels productive and changes nothing.
- Break it, then look again. The constraint moves. That's how you know you're growing.

ACTION

→ Name your one constraint in a sentence, with the number that proves it.

13.2 MORE CLIENTS, BIGGER CLIENTS, MORE PER CLIENT

13.2

BIG IDEA

There are only three ways to grow revenue. Pick the one your machine can handle right now.

TALKING POINTS

- More clients means more leads and more closes. Your lead machine from Course 04 has to be running first.
- Bigger clients means the same work for buyers with bigger budgets. Often it's the same hours for a bigger check.
- More per client means more services, longer contracts, or a higher tier for the clients you already have.
- More per client is usually the fastest. They already trust you. Clients who stay 12, 24, 38 months are worth far more than new ones.
- Bigger clients is usually the most profitable. Value pricing scales with the size of the buyer.
- Pick one of the three for the next 90 days. Doing all three at once is how you do none of them.

STORY

[STORY: the first time you went after a bigger client, and what changed in the offer or the price]

ACTION

→ Pull your client list and write down which of the three levers would add the most revenue in 90 days, with the number.

13.3 ADD OFFERS

Build the ladder.

BIG IDEA

Build the ladder. Give clients a next step up, so you're not starting from zero with every sale.

TALKING POINTS

- A ladder is a set of offers in order, from the first yes to the biggest engagement.
- The bottom rung is easy to say yes to. The top rung is where the money and the long contracts are.
- Every new offer should use the same team, the same systems and the same buyers. If it needs a new machine, it's a new business.
- Add one rung at a time. Prove it sells and delivers before you add the next.
- Make the next step obvious. Every client should know what comes after the thing they bought.
- More offers isn't the goal. A clear path up is.

ACTION

→ Draw your ladder: what you sell now, one rung below it and one rung above it, with a price on each.

13.4 NEW MARKETS, SAME MACHINE

Clone what works into the next niche.

BIG IDEA

Clone what works into the next niche. Same offer, same process, same team, new buyer.

TALKING POINTS

- Once the machine works in one market, the cheapest growth is pointing it at another.
- Pick a niche that buys the same outcome. The work barely changes. The language and the list do.
- Rewrite the offer in their words, build a new list of 100 buyers, and run the same outreach.
- Use a case study from your first market. Proof travels.
- Don't change the delivery to fit the new market. If you have to rebuild the machine, it's the wrong market.
- Run it as a test for 30 days. If the conversations come, scale it. If they don't, kill it and try the next niche.

STORY

Grove Central case study. [STORY: the first time you took what worked in one niche into another]

ACTION

→ Pick one adjacent niche, rewrite your offer sentence for it, and build a list of 100 buyers in it.

13.5 PARTNERSHIPS, EQUITY AND DEALS

When to take a stake instead of a fee.

BIG IDEA

When to take a stake instead of a fee. A fee pays you once. Equity pays you when the thing you helped build grows.

TALKING POINTS

- Once your machine produces real results for clients, the work itself becomes an asset you can trade.

- Take a stake when you believe in the business, your work is a big driver of its growth, and you can afford to wait for the payoff.
- Take the fee when the client can pay it, the upside is unclear, or you need the cash now.
- A lot of the best deals are both: a reduced fee plus equity or a share of revenue.
- Put everything in writing. Vesting, what you deliver, what happens if it ends. Get a lawyer on every equity deal.
- Never let equity deals starve the core business of cash. The machine pays the bills first.

STORY

[STORY: a deal where you took or turned down a stake instead of a fee, and why]

ACTION

→ List your current clients and partners, and mark any where a stake or revenue share would be worth more than the fee.

13.6 BUILD SOMETHING YOU CAN SELL

Designing for an exit.

BIG IDEA

Designing for an exit. A business you can sell is the same as a finished business, with the paperwork done.

TALKING POINTS

- Even if you never sell, build it like you will. It makes the business better to own.
- A buyer pays for three things: recurring revenue, a team that runs it without you, and clean numbers.
- Recurring contracts beat one-off projects every time. That's why we put clients on contracts from Course 03.
- If the business depends on you, a buyer is buying a job. Get out of the work first.
- Clean books, written SOPs, a CRM with the full history. That's what makes a business something a buyer can trust.
- Know what you'd want for it. A number on paper changes how you run it.

ACTION

→ Score your business out of ten on recurring revenue, owner independence and clean numbers, and write the one fix for your lowest score.

13.7 THE NEXT LEVEL OF YOU

The person who can hold what you're building.

BIG IDEA

The person who can hold what you're building. The business grows to the size of the owner, so you grow first.

TALKING POINTS

- Your business is a reflection of your standard. A bigger business needs a bigger standard.
- The habits that got you here – doing it yourself, being in every decision – are what cap you now.
- The next level is calmer, not busier. Fewer decisions, better ones.
- Rich, Fit, Sick doesn't stop when the business grows. Train every day. Read. Hold the standard.
- Spend time around people who are already where you're going. Your ceiling rises to the room.
- Write down who you have to become to run the business you described. Then act like that person this week.

STORY

[STORY: a moment when you had to change yourself before the business could grow]

ACTION

→ Write one paragraph on the person who can run the business you're building, and one habit you start this week to become them.

THE ASSIGNMENT – COURSE 13

Name your constraint and your one move for the next 90 days.

Start with your scoreboard, not your gut. Name the one constraint in a sentence with the number that proves it, then pick one move that breaks it in the next 90 days. Good looks like: 'My constraint is sales – we get 40 leads a month and close 4. My move is hiring and training a closer by day 30.' One constraint, one move, one owner, one number. Post it in the community and bring it to the live call.

In the Vault: 90-day scale plan

14

COURSE 14 · WEEK 12 · STEP OUT · 7 LESSONS

THE LIFE

Freedom, health, wealth and relationships.

This is the reason for everything we've done in the last eleven weeks. The business was never the point. The life it pays for is, so we're going to write it down and put it on the calendar.

YOU LEAVE WITH The life the business is for – written down and on the calendar.

14.1 NOBODY ACTUALLY WANTS A COMPANY

14.1

BIG IDEA

You don't want a company. You want what a company gives you. Get clear on that, or you'll build a business that owns you.

TALKING POINTS

- Nobody dreams about payroll and client calls. They dream about time, freedom, and the people they love.
- The company is the vehicle. If you forget that, you'll keep building the vehicle and never go anywhere.
- Ask yourself what you'd do with the company if it ran itself tomorrow. That answer is what you actually want.
- Most owners who burn out built the business they thought they should, not the life they actually wanted.
- Write the life first. Then make the business serve it.
- If your business grew and your life didn't, you missed the point.

STORY

[STORY: the moment you realized the company was the vehicle, not the destination]

ACTION

→ Write three sentences on what you actually want the business to give you, without mentioning the business.

14.2 TIME FREEDOM

14.2

BIG IDEA

Time freedom is owning your calendar. You decide what goes on it, and the business doesn't need you to fill it.

TALKING POINTS

- Time freedom isn't doing nothing. It's choosing what you do.
- If you did the work in Course 07 and Course 12, you already bought back the hours. Now protect them.
- Block the life first. Training, family, trips, deep work. Then the business gets what's left.
- Keep your owner work to a fixed window. Scoreboard, manager check-in, the big decisions. That's it.
- If your calendar is full of things someone else could do, you've given the time back to the business.
- Free time fills up unless you design it. Protect it like a client meeting.

ACTION

→ Build your ideal week on the calendar, with the life blocked in first and the business in a fixed window.

14.3 LOCATION FREEDOM

Work from anywhere.

BIG IDEA

Work from anywhere. If the business runs from your phone, where you live is a choice, not a constraint.

TALKING POINTS

- Location freedom was designed in from day one. Remote team, CRM, scoreboard, phone.
- A national agency runs without me in the room. That's what makes the room optional.
- Start small. A long weekend away while the business runs. Then a week. Then longer.
- Before you go, check the basics: your manager knows what they decide, the numbers are on your phone, and nothing waits on you.
- Pay attention to what pulls you back in. Every one of those is a system to fix.
- Pick where you want to be and go. The business should follow you, not hold you.

ACTION

→ Choose a place you want to work from and book the dates.

14.4 FINANCIAL FREEDOM

Save, invest, and buy the life – not the number.

BIG IDEA

Save, invest, and buy the life – not the number. Know what your life costs, then build the money to pay for it without you working.

TALKING POINTS

- Most people chase a number. A number never feels like enough. A life does.
- Start with what your life actually costs. The real one you wrote down, not a guess.
- Pay yourself first, every month, from the business. Then save and invest a set amount before you spend.
- Keep business money and personal money separate. You set that up in Course 11.
- Build income that doesn't need you: the business running without you, and investments growing on their own.
- Financial freedom is when what comes in without your time covers what your life costs. Work it backwards like any target.

ACTION

→ Write what your life costs per month, and the amount you'll save and invest every month starting this month.

14.5 HEALTH

Train like it matters. It does.

BIG IDEA

Train like it matters. It does. Your body is the one asset the business can't replace.

TALKING POINTS

- Fit is in Rich, Fit, Sick for a reason. Train every day.
- Your energy sets the pace for the whole company. A tired owner makes tired decisions.
- Training is the first block on the calendar, not the one that gets moved when the day gets busy.
- Sleep, food and training. Get those three right and most of the rest follows.

- The Marine Corps taught me about showing up. That applies to your training as much as to your business.
- There's no point building freedom you don't have the health to enjoy.

STORY

Marine Corps taught me about showing up. [STORY: what your training looks like now, and how you protect it]

ACTION

→ Put your daily training on the calendar for the next 30 days and post your first week in the community.

14.6 RELATIONSHIPS

The people you're building it for.

BIG IDEA

The people you're building it for. If they don't get your time, the business took it.

TALKING POINTS

- Most of us say we're building this for our family. Then we give them what's left after the business.
- Write down the people who matter most. Then check how much of your week they actually get.
- Be present when you're with them. The phone stays down. The business can wait an hour. It's built to.
- Build it with the people close to you, not around them. Tell them what you're building and why.
- The right people around you raise your standard. Choose them on purpose.
- You can rebuild a business. You can't get back years you missed.

STORY

I walked my brother from wanting a company to running one fully remote at six figures a month. [STORY: what building with your brother meant to you beyond the business]

ACTION

→ Name the three people who matter most and put one block of undistracted time with each of them on the calendar.

14.7 GIVE BACK

Help the people coming up behind you.

BIG IDEA

Help the people coming up behind you. Teaching what you know is how you keep it, and how you pay it forward.

TALKING POINTS

- Someone helped you get here. Now you're the one who can help.
- Start in this room. Answer a question in the community. Share your numbers. Show your work.
- Teach what you just learned. You understand it better once you've taught it.
- Hire and train people. That's giving back too. I built my companies and trained the people who now run them. That's the most useful thing I know how to give.
- Give your time, your money or your skills. Pick one and make it regular, not occasional.
- A business that runs without you gives you the time to do this properly.

STORY

I trained the people who now run my companies. [STORY: someone who helped you when you were coming up]

ACTION

→ Pick one person a stage behind you and help them this week, in the community or in real life.

THE ASSIGNMENT – COURSE 14

Write down the life you're building toward – and put the first trip on the calendar.

Write the life you're building toward in plain language: where you live, what your week looks like, who you spend it with, how you train, and what it costs per month. Keep it specific enough that you'd know when you're living it. Then put the first trip on the calendar with real dates, not 'sometime this year.' Good looks like a one-page description of your life and a booked trip, posted in the community.